Reading practice booklet: Grade 0 expectations

KG2 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Reading at Grade 0 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Sounds, letters and decoding

Standards practised: RF.K.1d, RF.K.2a, RF.K.2b, RF.K.2c, RF.K.2d, RF.K.3a, RF.K.3c

A worked example

Parent says: "Listen to the word sun. What sound do you hear at the start of sun?"

1. Say the word slowly: sss-un.
2. The first sound you hear is /s/.
3. The letter that makes this sound is s.

The first sound in sun is /s/.

Questions

1. Parent writes a capital B and a small b. Ask: "Are these the same letter?"

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2. Say the word sun. Which letter does sun begin with?

   A. n

   B. s

   C. u

3. What sound does the letter m make, as in moon?

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4. Which word rhymes with cat?

   A. sun

   B. pen

   C. hat

5. Listen to bed, red, bus. Which word does not rhyme with the others?

   A. bus

   B. bed

   C. red

6. Clap the parts of the word camel (cam-el). How many claps?

   A. One

   B. Two

   C. Three

7. What is the first sound in the word pen?

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8. What is the last sound in the word sun?

   A. /s/

   B. /u/

   C. /n/

9. Put these sounds together: /k/ /a/ /t/. What word do they make?

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10. What is the middle sound in the word pen?

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11. Parent writes three words: the, and, is. Ask the child to point to the word "and".

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12. Say the word hen. Now change the first sound /h/ to /p/. What new word do you make?

Section 2: Understanding what you read

Standards practised: RL.K.1, RL.K.2, RL.K.3, SL.K.2

A worked example

Parent reads the story aloud, then asks: "Who went to the souq with Maryam and Hamdan?"

1. Listen for the words about who went.
2. The story says they went with their grandmother.

Their grandmother went with them.

A Day at the Souq

Maryam and her little brother Hamdan went to the souq with their grandmother. It was a hot day in Dubai. First, they bought a bag of sweet dates. Next, they went to the shop with the shiny lamps. Hamdan wanted a blue lamp, but Maryam liked the red one. Grandmother bought the red lamp for the home. Then the children drank cold juice under a big tree. They were happy, and they all went home together.

Questions

1. Where did the children go?

   A. To the souq

   B. To the beach

   C. To school

2. Who went to the souq with Maryam and Hamdan?

   _____

3. What was the weather like?

   A. Cold

   B. Hot

   C. Rainy

4. What did the family buy first?

   A. A red lamp

   B. Cold juice

   C. A bag of sweet dates

5. After they bought the dates, where did they go next?

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6. Which colour of lamp did Hamdan want?

   A. A blue lamp

   B. A red lamp

   C. A green lamp

7. Which lamp did Grandmother buy?

   A. The blue lamp

   B. The green lamp

   C. The red lamp

8. Who is Hamdan's sister?

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9. What did the children drink?

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10. Where did the children drink their juice?

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11. Which happened first: buying the dates or drinking the juice?

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12. What did they do at the end of the story?

Section 3: Word meanings and how writers use words

Standards practised: L.K.5a, L.K.5b, L.K.5c

A worked example

Parent asks: "What is the opposite of hot?"

1. Think of how ice or cold juice feels.
2. Hot and cold are opposites.

Cold.

Questions

1. What is the opposite of big?

   A. Tall

   B. Small

   C. Loud

2. What is the opposite of up?

   _____

3. What is the opposite of wet?

   A. Cold

   B. Muddy

   C. Dry

4. What is the opposite of full? Think of an empty cup.

   _____

5. What is the opposite of open?

   _____

6. Apple, banana and grapes all belong to one group. What is the group called?

   A. Fruit

   B. Animals

   C. Toys

7. Red, blue and green are all kinds of what?

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8. Car, bus and spoon: which one does not belong with the others, and why?

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9. Which word is an action word?

   A. red

   B. jump

   C. tree

10. A falcon can fly. A fish can swim. Which word tells what a fish does?

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11. A creek is a narrow stretch of water where boats can go. Where could a boat go: on a creek or on a street?

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12. Tiny means very, very small. Which one is tiny?

    A. A camel

    B. A house

    C. An ant

Section 4: Writing and language

Standards practised: L.K.1a, L.K.2a, L.K.2b, L.K.5a, SL.K.1

A worked example

Parent asks: "Which is written the right way, salem or Salem?"

1. A name starts with a capital letter.
2. Salem has a capital S at the start.

Salem.

Questions

1. Does the first letter of a name, like Maryam, start with a capital (big) letter or something else?

   A. A small letter

   B. A number

   C. A capital letter

2. Which name is written correctly?

   A. noura

   B. Noura

   C. nOura

3. Parent writes: the sun is hot. and The sun is hot. Which sentence starts the right way?

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4. Parent writes: Thesunishot and The sun is hot. Which one has spaces between the words?

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5. What small mark goes at the end of a sentence that tells something?

   A. A comma

   B. A question mark

   C. A full stop

6. Put these words in order to make a sentence: cat, The, sat.

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7. How many words are in this sentence: I like dates.

   A. Three

   B. Two

   C. Four

8. Parent writes b and d. Which letter has a tall line with a round belly on the right side?

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9. Camel, dates, falcon and bread. Which two are animals?

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10. Car, bus and bike are all ways to do what?

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11. Which one can you wear?

    A. A tree

    B. A shoe

    C. A cloud

12. When a friend is telling you something, what should you do?

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Sounds, letters and decoding

1. Yes. Capital B and small b are the same letter in two sizes. Ask: which one is the big one, and which is the small one?
2. B. s. The letter s, because sun starts with the sound /s/. If your child chose n, they picked the last sound, not the first.
3. A good answer says /m/, like the start of moon. Say it with a humming mouth. Ask: can you hum it for me?
4. C. hat. Hat, because cat and hat end with the same sound, at. If your child chose sun, they listened to the wrong part of the word.
5. A. bus. Bus, because bed and red end the same way and bus does not. If your child chose bed, they may have matched the first sound b, not the ending.
6. B. Two. claps, one for cam and one for el. If your child chose Three, they may have clapped for every sound, not every part.
7. A good answer is /p/, the sound at the very start. Say pen slowly. Ask: what do your lips do for the first sound?
8. C. /n/. because sun ends with n. If your child chose /s/, they gave the first sound, not the last one.
9. Cat. A good answer blends the three sounds smoothly: k, then a, then t. Ask: can you say it faster?
10. A good answer is /e/, the sound in the middle of pen. Ask: what sound do you hear between p and n?
11. The middle word, the second one. A good answer points to the word with a, n and d. Ask: which letter does it start with?
12. Pen. A good answer changes only the first sound, h to p, and keeps en. Ask: which sound is the same in both words?

Section 2: Understanding what you read

1. A. To the souq. because the story says Maryam and Hamdan went to the souq. If your child chose the beach, they may have guessed from the hot day.
2. Their grandmother. A good answer names the person from the first sentence. Ask: which words in the story tell you that?
3. B. Hot. because the story says it was a hot day in Dubai. If your child chose Cold, they may have remembered the cold juice.
4. C. A bag of sweet dates. because the story says First, they bought dates. If your child chose Cold juice, they picked something from the end.
5. The shop with the shiny lamps, because the story says Next. A good answer uses that word. Ask: what did they buy there?
6. A. A blue lamp. because the story says Hamdan wanted a blue lamp. If your child chose A red lamp, they mixed him up with Maryam.
7. C. The red lamp. because Grandmother bought the red lamp for the home. If your child chose The blue lamp, they picked the lamp Hamdan wanted.

8. Maryam. A good answer names the girl who went with her little brother. Ask: which words tell you she is his sister?
9. Cold juice. A good answer names what they drank, near the end of the story. Ask: where in the story did you hear that?
10. Under a big tree. A good answer says where, and the story tells us near the end. Ask: what did the tree give them?
11. Buying the dates came first, because the story says First, they bought dates. Ask: which word tells you it was first?
12. They all went home together. A good answer tells the last thing that happened. Ask: how did they feel at the end?

Section 3: Word meanings and how writers use words

1. B. Small. because it is the opposite of big. If your child chose Tall, they picked another size word that is not the opposite.
2. Down. A good answer says the word that is as different from up as can be. Ask: can you point up, then point down?
3. C. Dry. because wet and dry are opposites. If your child chose Cold, they thought of how wet things feel, not the opposite.
4. Empty. A good answer is the word for a cup with nothing in it. Ask: what is in a full cup, and what is in this one?
5. Close or shut. A good answer says what you do to a door that is open. Ask: what do you do to a door to shut it?
6. A. Fruit. because apples, bananas and grapes are all fruit. If your child chose Toys, they may have thought of things to play with, not to eat.
7. Colours. A good answer names the group that red, blue and green all belong to. Ask: can you name another colour?
8. Spoon, because a car and a bus carry people and a spoon does not. Ask: how do we use a spoon, and how do we use a bus?
9. B. jump. Jump, because it is something you do. If your child chose tree, they picked a thing, not an action.
10. Swim. A good answer finds what the fish does in the sentence. Ask: which words tell you that a fish swims?
11. On a creek, because a creek is water and a boat floats on water. Ask: why can a boat not go on a street?
12. C. An ant. because an ant is very, very small. If your child chose A house, they picked something big, not tiny.

Section 4: Writing and language

1. C. A capital letter. because names start with a big letter. If your child chose A small letter, they forgot that names are special.
2. B. Noura. because the N is a capital and the other letters are small. If your child chose nOura, they put the capital in the wrong place.
3. The second one, because a sentence starts with a capital letter. Ask: which letter is big at the start of The?

4. The second one, because it has a gap between each word. Ask: can you touch each gap with your finger?
5. C. A full stop. a little dot, because a sentence that tells something ends with it. If your child chose A question mark, they picked the mark for asking.
6. The cat sat. A good answer starts with The, then says who, then what they did. Ask: does it sound right when you read it?
7. A. Three. words: I, like and dates. If your child chose Two, they may have missed the little word I.
8. The letter b. The tall line is on the left and the belly is on the right. Ask: which letter has its belly on the other side?
9. Camel and falcon, because they are living animals and dates and bread are food. Ask: which two can we eat?
10. Travel. A good answer says these things take us to places. Ask: how did you come here today?
11. B. A shoe. because you put it on your foot. If your child chose A cloud, they picked something in the sky, not something to wear.
12. Listen and wait for your turn to talk. A good answer says to be quiet and look at them. Ask: what do you do with your ears?